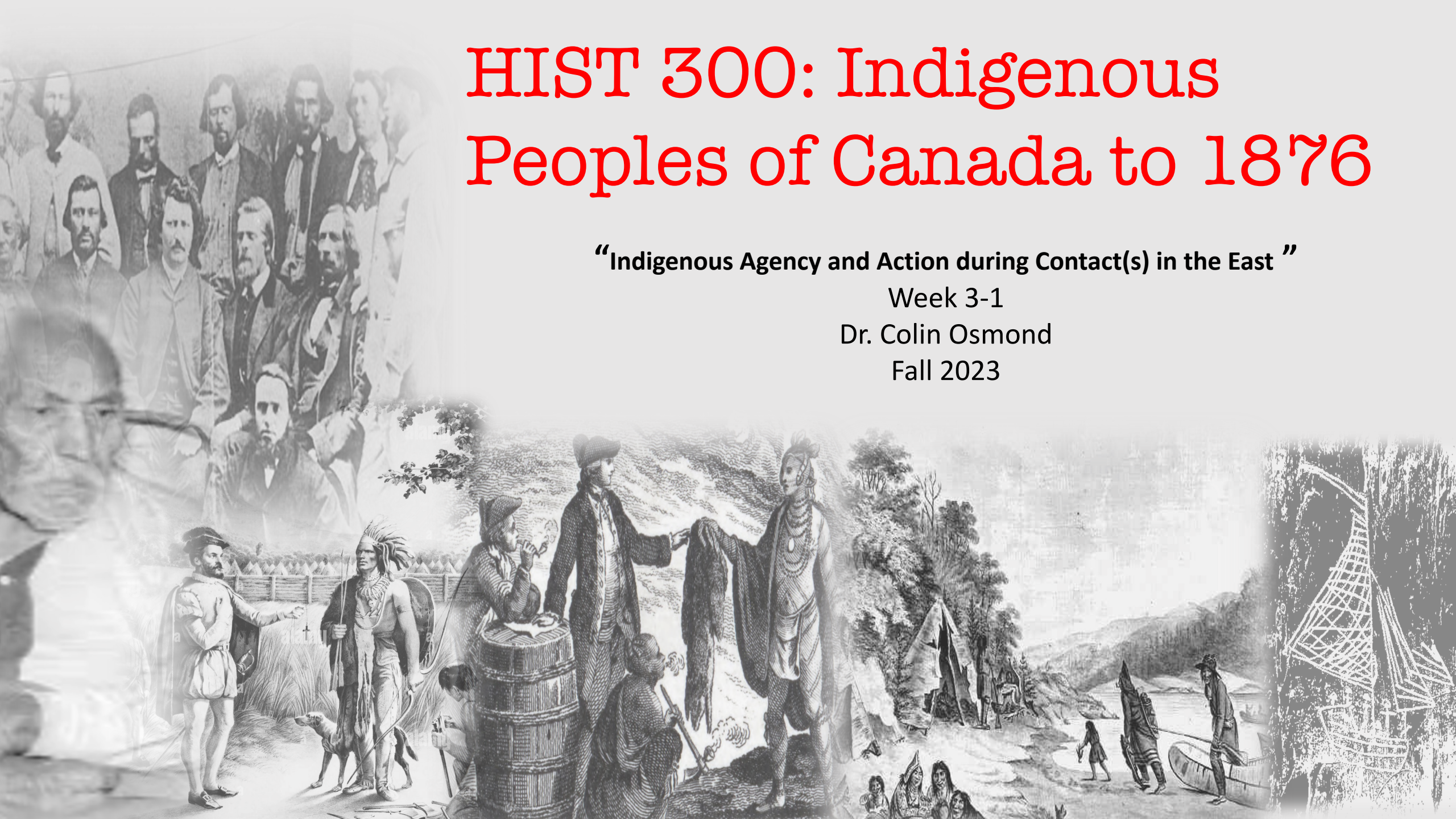
HIST 300: Indigenous Peoples of Canada to 1876

"Indigenous Agency and Action during Contact(s) in the East "

Week 3-1

Dr. Colin Osmond

Fall 2023



Recap:

- First encounters – Norse ~1000AD
- Beothuk adopted strategy of minimal relations/trade and dispersal
- Seasonal colonialism at first, slow build to settler pop.
- Beothuk retreat, competition for resources
- Myth of Beothuk “extinction”
- Settler obsession with Terra Nullius
- Myth of the virgin landscape

Learning Outcomes/Keyword

- First Encounters with Europeans – case studies of Indigenous leaders and how they accepted/rejected certain aspects of colonial society
- Various types of colonialism at play – not just settler colonialism
- Sagamow (Grand Chief) Henri Membertou
- Donnacona (Chief of St. Lawrence Iroquois)
- Membertou and Donnacona's actions highlight examples of Indigenous action and agency – not passive participation
- Through these case studies, we can try and see colonialism as part of Indigenous histories, rather than these leaders within a colonial history
- *Keywords: Membertou, Acadia, Port Royal, Donnacona, St. Lawrence Iroquois, Stadacona, Hochelaga, Jacques Cartier, Indigenous Agency*

Chief Henri Membertou

ict Chief (Sagamow) of Kespukwitk (“Land’s End” – south-western
ma’ki - Nova Scotia)

ointed Grand Chief of Mi’kma’ki

y born around 1507, died 1611

Jacques Cartier in 1534

known and widely respected leader, healer, prophet, warrior, and
er.

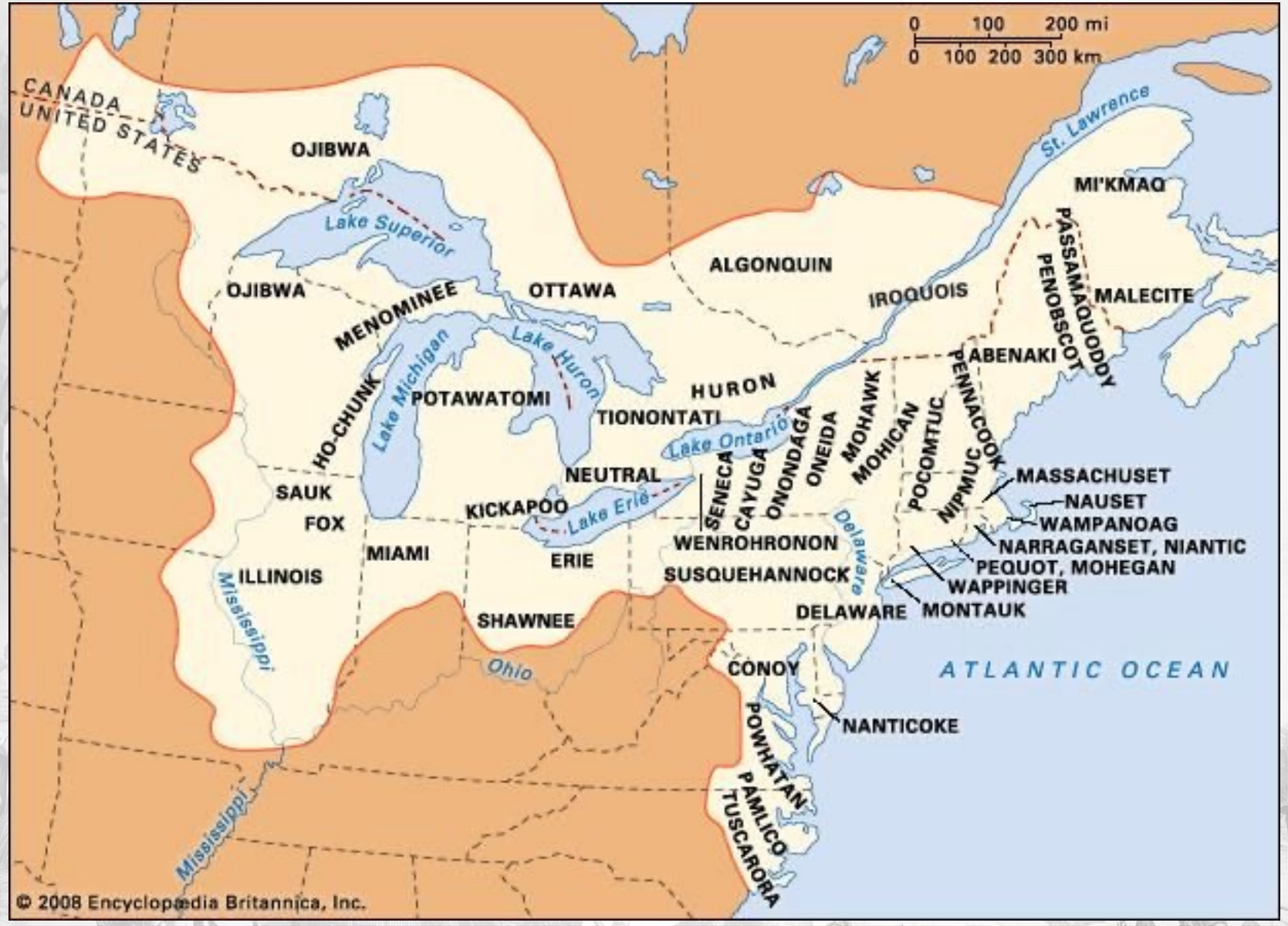
ned partnerships with French at Port Royal

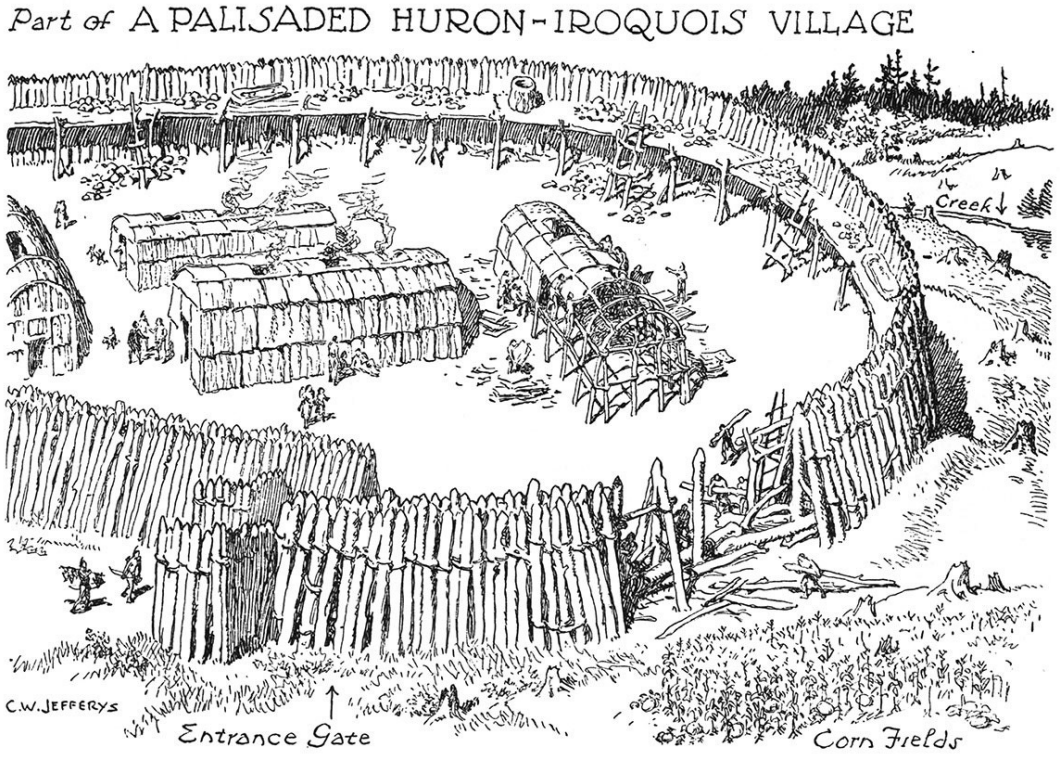
pted Catholicism, owned a sailboat, developed trade networks for
ch goods

matic leader – made decisions at an important time based on his
erstanding of the quickly changing world

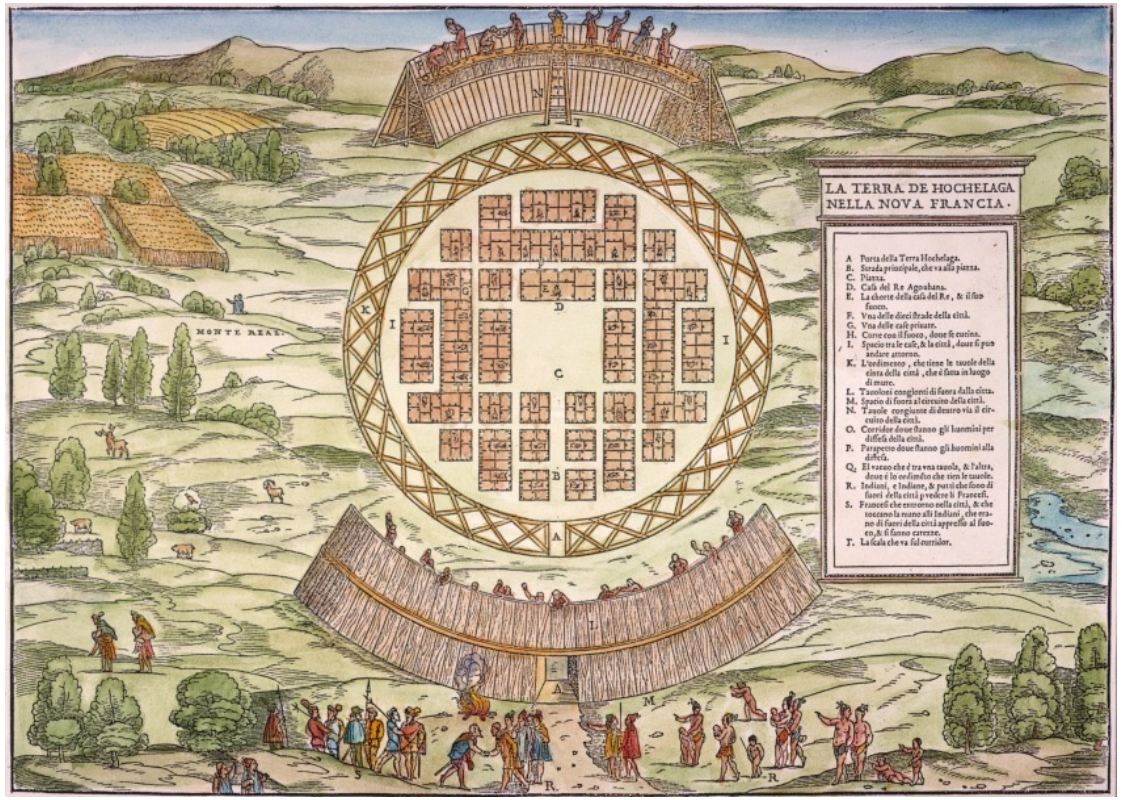


Portrait of Membertou, Mi’kmaw Artist Alan Syliboy


0 100 200 mi
0 100 200 300 km
CANADA
UNITED STATES
OJIBWA
Lake Superior
OJIBWA
MENOMINEE
OTTAWA
ALGONQUIN
IROQUOIS
St. Lawrence
MI'KMAQ
PASSAMAQUODDY
PENOBSCOT
MALECITE
ABENAKI
Lake Michigan
Lake Huron
HO-CHUNK
POTAWATOMI
HURON
TIONONTATI
Lake Ontario
SENECA
CAYUGA
ONONDAGA
ONEIDA
MOHAWK
MOHICAN
POCOMTUC
PENNACOOK
NIPMUC
MASSACHUSET
NAUSET
WAMPANOAG
NARRAGANSET, NIANTIC
PEQUOT, MOHEGAN
WAPPINGER
MONTAUK
NEUTRAL
SAUK
FOX
KICKAPOO
Lake Erie
WENROHRONON
SUSQUEHANNOCK
DELAWARE
Delaware
MIAMI
ERIE
ILLINOIS
Mississippi
SHAWNEE
Ohio
CONOY
NANTICOKE
POWHATAN
PAMLICO
TUSCARORA
ATLANTIC OCEAN
Mississippi
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Huron-Iroquois Village, ca. 1500



Hochelaga (Montreal), 1556

- Members of Saint Lawrence Iroquois made contact with Cartier ships at Gaspe Bay in 1534
- Led by Donnacona – several hundred people fishing when Cartier arrived
- Famous event – raising the French Cross
  - For Cartier, a sign of French ownership
  - For Donnacona – a symbol that would mark a trading site
- Domagaya and Taigoagny (Donnacona's sons) go to France with Cartier
- Cartier returned with sons in 1535, spent winter at Stadacona (present day Quebec City)
- Indigenous people provided food and medicine for Cartier and Crew
- Relationship fell apart when Cartier ignored Donnacona's requests that they not travel further up the river
- Cartier visited Hochelaga
- Cartier kidnapped Donnacona and 10 0thers and took them to France in 1536



"Cartier", by Aislin (1996)

- Donnacona held prisoner in Paris from 1536-1539
- Reported to the French King of resource rich lands at “Saugenay”
- Told the French if he could return home, he would bring them there
- All of Cartier’s Captives died in France
- Why did Donnacona embrace Cartier (at first)?
  - Sent his sons as diplomats – common in Indigenous world
  - Likely had already met other Europeans *before* Cartier
  - Acting Strategically – new ally, new trade market
- Cartier returned to Stadacona in 1543
- St. Lawrence Iroquois (Donnacona’s Nation) were gone
  - European diseases
  - Dispersal after loss of Donnacona
  - Haudenosaunee push into the area
  - Dispersal into other Nations



”Cartier”, by Aislin (1996)



"Meeting of Two Cultures in the 16th Century", Monument in Anse-a-Cartier Park, Quebec

Donnacona (left) and Cartier (right) on two granite pillars, separated by a large block of granite representing the Atlantic Ocean

Next Class:

- **Sept 21 Indigenous Empires and the development of the Fur Trade**

- ***Read:*** Jon Parmenter, “After the Mourning Wars”, 39-76.

- Belshaw: Pgs. 84-89